

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 7 3
 ♥ 10
 ♦ J 10 9 8 5 2
 ♣ Q 5

♠ A K 9 4

♥ K Q 6

♦ A Q 4

♣ 10 8 6



♠ 10 6 2

♥ 7 3

♦ K 7 6 3

♣ A 9 4 2

♠ Q 5

♥ A J 9 8 5 4 2

♦ -

♣ K J 7 3

West	North	East	South
	1♣	Pass	1♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

6♥ by South

Lead: ♦ J
 have been ♣s, and he has discarded 2 of them.

[showcards W:DJ]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown, (wild).

Partner led the ♦ J; ♦ Q from dummy, ♦ K from you
 and ruffed by South.

South then pulls two rounds of trumps, (West
 discards on the second one), followed by his ♠ Q,
 dummy's ♠ A K and dummy's ♦ A. South discards
 ♣s on the last two cards.

The ♣6 is then played from dummy and you must
 make a decision - ♣A or ♣2?

Play the ♣2.

You have a full count on South's hand. He started
 with 2 ♠s, 7 ♥s, and no ♦s. His other 4 cards must

So he has 2 ♣s left in his hand. If one of them is the ♣K and you play your ♣A then you have handed him
 the contract.

By playing low you give him a guess to make. If he plays the ♣K he will make the contract, but if he plays
 the ♣J he will go down. He will probably play the ♣J, figuring you wouldn't have the nerve to duck with the
 ♣A. He'll know better next time he plays against you.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 4
 ♥ 7 4
 ♦ J 9 7 5 4
 ♣ A J 3

♠ 8 6 2

♥ A K Q J 10

♦ 8 3

♣ Q 10 6

	N	
W		E
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♠ A 10 7 3

♥ 8 6 5 2

♦ 10 6 2

♣ 8 4

♠ J 9 5

♥ 9 3

♦ A K Q

♣ K 9 7 5 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♦ 5			
tricks.			

[showcards S:C9]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♦ 5; ♦ 3, ♦ 10 and won by South with
 ♦ K. South now leads the ♣ 9 from his hand

Play the ♣ A.

First ask yourself "Where are the ♦ A and ♦ Q?" East doesn't have either one or he would have played it at the first trick. So South has both of them. So with those 3 tricks and the 5 ♥s in dummy South only needs to find one more winner. Assuming he has the ♣ K, (or why play the suit), if you play low he will find that one more winner whichever high ♣ he plays.

Next ask yourself "Where is the ♠ A?" Clearly East **DOES** have this card; otherwise South has his 9

So the way to beat the contract is to go up with your ♣ A, then play ♠ K, ♠ Q and a third ♠, hoping East holds ♠ A x x x.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 2
♥ A Q 6 4 3
♦ 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ A K

♥ 10 9 7

♦ 10 9 6 2

♣ K Q 8 5



♠ J 9 7 4 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 8 5

♣ 9 7 4

♠ Q 10 6

♥ K J 8

♦ K Q J 3

♣ A J 2

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥4

As you see, this will defeat the contract. Had you played a low ♦ South would have pocketed that trick and added 4 ♣s and 3 ♠s to go with the ♥ he had already won.

[showcards N:DT]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥4, won by South's ♥8.

South enters dummy with the ♠K and leads the ♦10. What do you play?

Play the ♦A.

You don't have much in your hand, but you do have the ♦A, and you also have the responsibility to help West set up his suit.

So even though you don't know for sure how good that suit is, your plan of action should be to take the ♦A and return a ♥.

Board 4

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 8 7 4

♥ J 8 7 2

♦ 10 2

♣ K J

♠ 9 5 3

♥ A Q

♦ A 6

♣ Q 10 9 8 5 2



♠ 6 2

♥ 10 9 4

♦ Q J 8 7 4

♣ A 7 4

♠ A Q J

♥ K 6 5 3

♦ K 9 5 3

♣ 6 3

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♣

Pass

1 ♦

Pass

2 ♣

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ 7

You can be sure East has the ♣ A because South would have played the suit differently if he held the Ace.

East will win the ♣ A and return his ♠ through South's ♠ A Q. This allows you to set up your ♠ suit while you still have the ♣ K for an entry.

[showcards S:C6]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♠ 7; ♠ 3, ♠ 2 and won by South with ♠ Q.

South then plays the ♣ 6 from his hand. Which ♣ should you play?

Play the ♣ J.

You should not allow yourself to be misled by South winning the first trick with the ♠ Q. East does not hold either the ♠ A or the ♠ J or he would have played it. South is just trying to be deceptive.

That means you need the next ♠ play to come from East, so you play your ♣ J and let East win his ♣ A.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 8 5 3 2

♥ 7 3

♦ Q J 10

♣ 9 4

♠ K 6

♥ 8 5 2

♦ 9 7 5 4 2

♣ Q 7 3



♠ 7

♥ 9 6 4

♦ K 8 6 3

♣ J 10 8 6 2

♠ A J 9 4

♥ A K Q J 10

♦ A

♣ A K 5

West	North	East	South
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Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

Pass

3♥

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by South

Lead: ♦ Q

[showcards N:S6]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♦ Q, you signaled with the ♦ 8 and South won the ♦ A.

South then played low to dummy's ♠ K, and led dummy's ♠ 6. Your decision is not whether to play high or low, but whether to ruff or not, which amounts to the same thing.

Do not ruff.

Even though South holds the ♠ A, if you ruff now he will just put on a small ♠ and you will be ruffing a loser. Instead discard a ♦.

South will win the ♠ A, but will not be able to ruff any ♠ losers in dummy because your trumps can overruff any of North's trumps.

Suppose you had ruffed the ♠. South would have played his ♠ 9, leaving himself with ♠ A J. He would then get the lead and pull your two remaining trumps. That would leave one trump in dummy to ruff his ♠ J, his only remaining loser.

Board 6

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 2
♥ Q 3
♦ Q J 10 6
♣ K Q J 8

♠ J 6 3

♥ A K 10 9 8

♦ 8 2

♣ 10 9 4



♠ A 10 7 4
♥ J 6 5 2
♦ 9 5 4
♣ 5 3

♠ K 8 5

♥ 7 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ A 7 6 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	1NT
All Pass			
1NT by South			
Lead: ♣K			

[showcards S:H4]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♣K and continue with the ♣J then ♣Q, taken by South's ♣A. To trick 4 South plays the ♥4. What do you play?

Play the ♥Q.

To see why you should play the ♥Q, just visualize the result if you play low. South will finesse with dummy's ♥8. If East wins his ♥J on this trick there will be 4 good ♥ tricks in dummy. If East withholds his ♥J then Declarer will have 3 ♥ winners.

Now visualize the result of playing the ♥Q. Whether South takes this trick or not he cannot win more than 2 ♥s.